

LEAD OPPONENT SCOUTING REPORT

Opponent: Rutgers Scarlet Knights

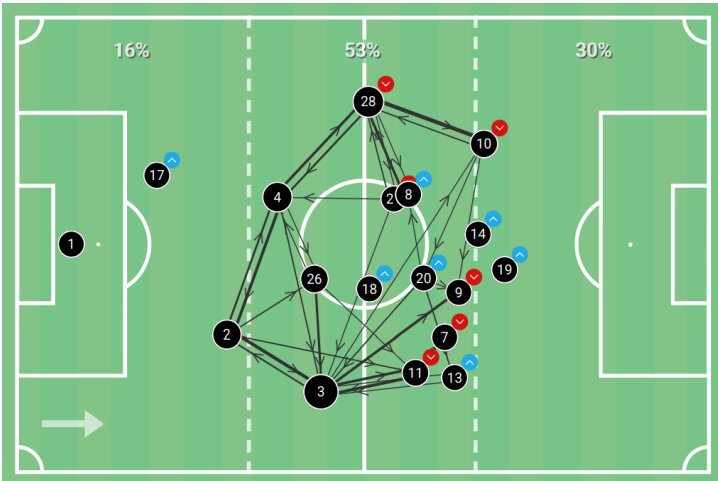
Date of Match: 10/10

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Opponent Record: 7-2-2 in Fall 2025 (most recently 0-0 against Michigan Wolverines)

Overall Team Overview (over last 6 games):

Rutgers is a balanced, attack-minded team that can build through possession or go direct to a target forward. They're effective in transition, especially through wide players. Offensively, they use central hold-up play to draw defenders in before switching wide to isolate wingers and overlap fullbacks. #10 is their primary creator (3.02 xG over the last six), with most of their threat coming from service, averaging 14-15 crosses per game, typically aimed at #9 Kitch or the back post for late runners. Set pieces, including corners and long throws (often from the right back), are a key weapon, targeting #4, #3, and #20. Defensively, they're vulnerable in transition, often exposing space behind their high line, and struggle to clear the box cleanly, leaving them open to second chances. While capable in possession, they're comfortable going direct when pressed, using midfielders to play off knock-downs from #9 to trigger quick attacks (up-back-through).



Passing matrix vs Penn State

PPDA	8.62	Moderate pressing out of a 4-1 block
Average Possession %	49.56%	Comfortable in possession and also effective playing direct and transitional
Passes per Possession	3.8	Higher number of passes in possession relative to other Big Ten competition
xG per 90	1.81	High attacking output, especially from transition play and set pieces
Shots/Crosses per 90	14/19	Willingness to create variety of chances, especially down the wings

In Possession:

- Shape: 4-3-3 or 4-1-4-1
- During buildup, back 3 shape with LB high and RB tucked in, through CMs (#26, #21, #7/#20)
- Rely on central hold-up play and distribution to release width

Out of Possession:

- Shape: 4-1-4-1 (mid to high block)
- Moderate press (PPDA ~8.62); looking to shape play and deny central penetration
- Space exposed behind during buildup and vulnerability on counter

Key Players:

- #10 – Joschi Schelb (Winger, CAM)
 - 7 G + 1 A on the season
 - Set piece taker, creative and direct attacker
- #11 – Dan Karsten (Winger)
 - 4 G + 3 A on the season
 - Left-footed, versatile player on wings and good dribbler

AI Perspective: Statistical analysis supports Rutgers’ transition-heavy, wide-focused attack (18.5 crosses/game) and strong xG output. However, 36.3% of possession losses occur in their offensive third and low clearance rate (10.3/game) reveal issues with box defense and transition coverage.